

MARKET ANALYSIS PROJECT

THE DRIVERS OF GAMING FATIGUE

A Comprehensive Study on Choice Paralysis, Playtime Inflation, and
the Sentiment Disconnect in the Modern Gaming Era.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Data-Driven Insights into Industry Burnout

CORE HYPOTHESIS & RESEARCH ERAS



THE HYPOTHESIS

Gaming fatigue is not merely "growing older." It is a **measurable market reality** driven by hyper-saturation and bloated design that devalues player time.



TEMPORAL SEGREGATION

Analysis focuses on two distinct eras: the **Golden Era (2000-2015)** characterized by high retention, and the **Modern Era (2016-Present)** defined by volume explosion.

| TECHNICAL METHODOLOGY



PROCESS

Data engineering of Steam & Global Sales sets using **Python (Pandas/NumPy)** to handle noise and feature engineering.



ANALYZE

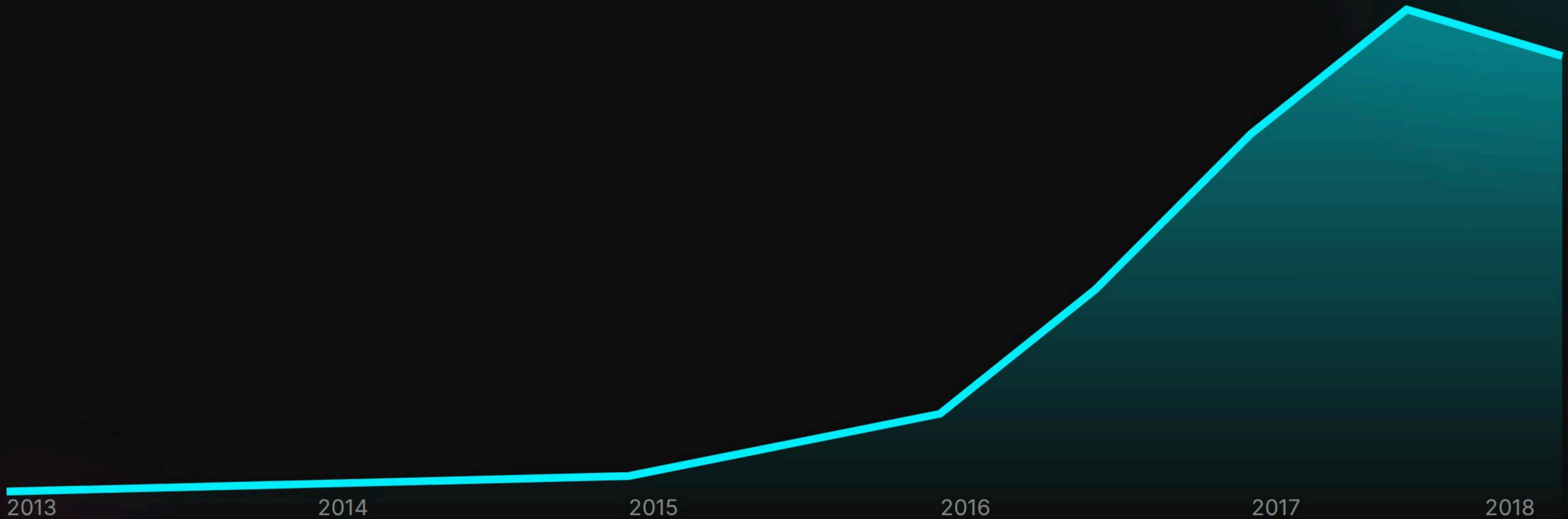
Advanced SQL querying in **Google BigQuery** using CTEs to calculate generational deltas and sentiment gaps.



SHARE

Interactive dashboarding in **Power BI** using dark-mode UX principles for executive storytelling.

FINDING 1: THE AVALANCHE OF CHOICE



Steam releases grew from **418 (2013)** to over **8,160 (2018)**. This 1,852% volume explosion triggers **Choice Paralysis**, devaluing the perceived novelty of new launches.

| FINDING 2: THE ENGAGEMENT CRASH

296

Golden Era (Min)

Focus and Retention

103

Modern Era (Min)

Fragmented Attention

65% DROP IN MEDIAN PLAYTIME

While the volume of games increased by 252%, player engagement per title crashed. Consumers are purchasing more, but abandoning games faster than ever before.

FINDING 3: GENRE SATURATION HEATMAP

Genre Category	Total Releases	Avg Median Playtime (Min)	Market Health
Action; Indie	1,852	75	Oversaturated
Casual; Indie	1,482	49	Oversaturated
Strategy	485	210	Healthy
Simulation	328	218	Healthy

Note: High release volume in Indie categories correlates with the lowest player retention (under 90 mins).

FINDING 4: THE GROWING DISCONNECT

Avg Critic Score (2016)

73.2

Avg User Score (2016)

67.7

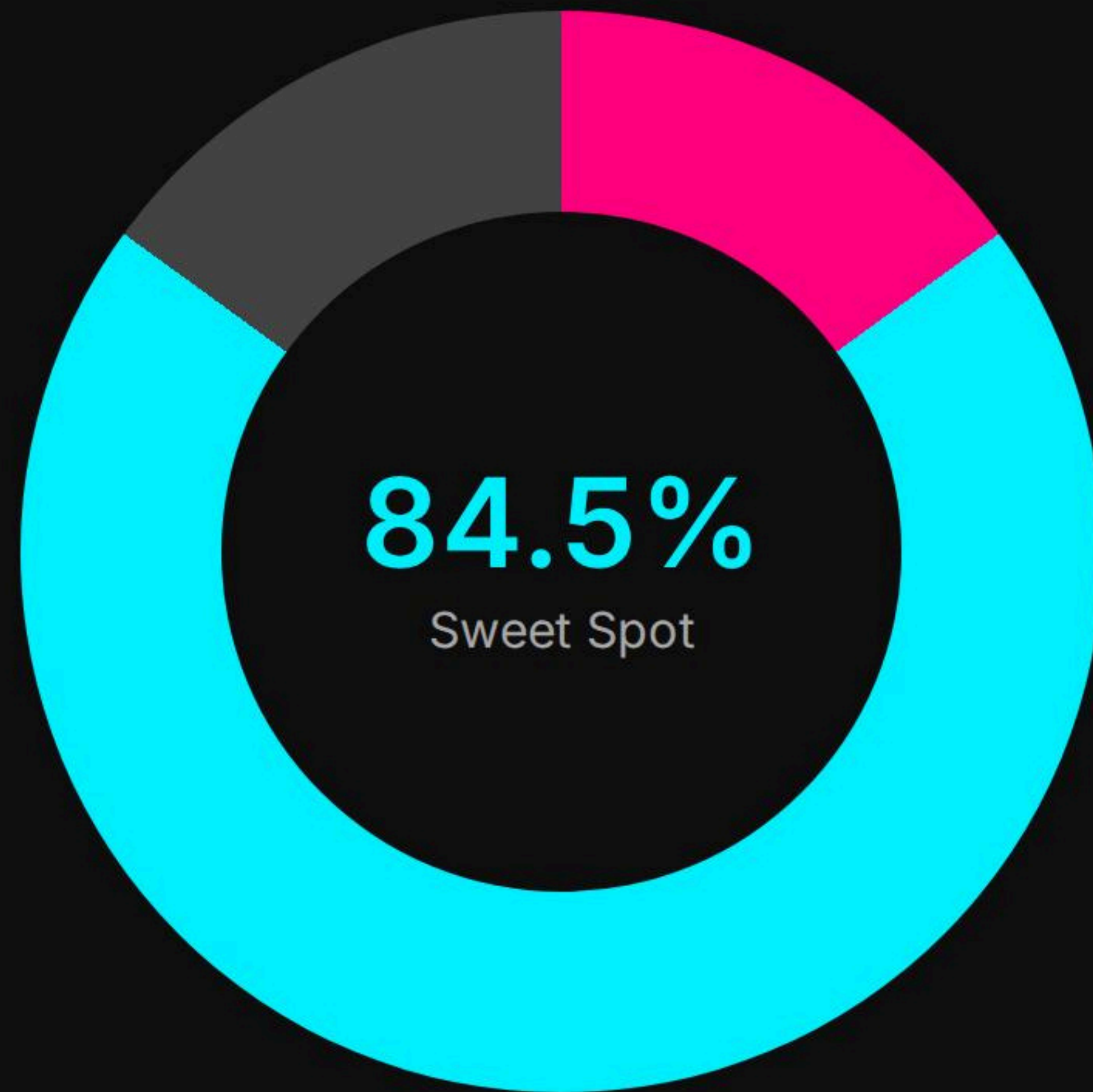
THE SENTIMENT GAP

Since 2012, a 5-point mathematical gap has emerged. Critics remain stable, but users—fatigued by design tropes—have become demonstrably harsher.

CONSUMER BURNOUT

This decoupling visualizes the loss of trust between professional industry reviewers and the veteran consumer base.

THE TIME INVESTMENT FACTOR



- **Medium (10-50 Hours):** 84.5% Positive Rating
- **Massive (50+ Hours):** 82.3% Positive Rating
- **Short (0-10 Hours):** 82.3% Positive Rating

Insight: Bloated game design (50+ hours) correlates with a **2.2% drop** in sentiment compared to the 10-50 hour "Sweet Spot."

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Quality Over Volume:** The market is saturated with "Action; Indie" titles. Developers should prioritize deep simulation or strategy mechanics which show 3x higher retention.
- **Respect Player Time:** Avoid the 50+ hour bloat. Data proves that 10-50 hour games maximize user satisfaction and prevent "burnout reviews."
- **The First 90 Minutes:** With modern playtimes averaging 103 minutes, the "hook" must be immediate. If engagement isn't locked early, abandonment is statistically inevitable.
- **Bridge the Sentiment Gap:** Industry critics are disconnected from user fatigue. Marketing must focus on authentic user-centric value rather than professional scores.



THANK YOU.

Questions & Discussion

Full SQL Code and Python Notebooks available in the **Analyze** and **Process** folders.